



ALEX KORMANN Minnesota Star Tribune

IMMIGRATION PROTESTS

Demonstrators mobilized, above, and hundreds of businesses shut down in Minnesota on Friday in protest of the federal immigration crackdown there. In Los Angeles, hundreds rallied in solidarity. **A6, B1**

Europe’s far right splits with Trump

President’s Greenland threats alienate groups that once saw him as an ideological ally.

By MICHAEL WILNER

NUUK, Greenland — One year ago, days before Donald Trump reclaimed power, the head of Denmark’s People’s Party took a trip to Mar-a-Lago. Morten Messerschmidt thought he

and Trump shared a common view on the perils of European integration. Together, he told local media at the time, they could make the West great again. In Europe, just as in the United States, Messerschmidt thought it was *nationale suverenitet* — national sovereignty — that over centuries had given countries large and small the tools to build their culture, traditions and institutions. Those were the values that conservative move-

ments across the European continent are fighting to protect. But Messerschmidt now finds himself on the defensive. The far-right politician is suddenly distancing himself from an American president who, off and on over the last year, has made aggressive plays to annex Greenland, targeting Danish borders that have existed for roughly 300 years. Trump pulled back from military threats against the island this week. “It’s total

access — there’s no end,” he said in an interview on Thursday with Fox Business. Asked whether he still intended on acquiring the island, Trump replied, “It’s possible. Anything is possible.” Despite Trump’s fixation on Greenland since his first term, he declined to meet with Messerschmidt at Mar-a-Lago last January. Instead, the Danish politician found himself discussing the matter with Marla Maples. [See Greenland, A6]

DOJ drops demand for hospital records

L.A. facility prevails in standoff over data on youths who got gender-affirming care.

By KEVIN RECTOR AND SONJA SHARP

The U.S. Department of Justice has agreed to stop demanding medical records that identify young patients who received gender-affirming care from Children’s Hospital Los Angeles, ending a legal standoff with families who sued to block a subpoena that some feared would be used to criminally prosecute the parents of transgender kids. The agreement, filed in federal court Thursday, allows the hospital to withhold certain records and redact personal information from others who underwent gender-affirming treatments, which Trump administration officials have compared to child mutilation despite support for such care by the nation’s major medical associations. Several parents of CHLA patients expressed profound relief Friday, while also acknowledging that other threats to their families remain. Jesse Thorn, the father of two transgender children who had been patients at Children’s Hospital, said

hospital officials have ignored his requests for information as to whether they had already shared his kids’ data with the Trump administration, which had been scary. Hearing they had not, and now won’t, provided “twofold” relief, he said. “The escalations have been so relentless in the threats to our family, and one of the things that compounded that was the uncertainty about what the federal government knew about our kids’ medical care and what they were going to do about that,” he said. Less clear is whether the agreement provides any new protections for doctors and other hospital personnel who provided care at the clinic and have also been targeted by the Trump administration. The agreement follows similar victories for families seeking to block such disclosures by gender-affirming care clinics elsewhere in the country, including a ruling Thursday for the families of transgender kids who received treatment at Children’s National Hospital in Washington, D.C. “What’s unique here is this was a class action,” said Alejandra Caraballo, a civil rights attorney and legal instructor at Harvard, who was not involved in the Los Angeles case. “I can’t undersell what a major win that is [See CHLA, A6]



GENARO MOLINA Los Angeles Times

**HOMES** in Carmel-by-the-Sea use whimsical names instead of street addresses.

Carmel chooses convenience over charm as addresses loom

By HAILEY BRANSON-POTTS

City Hall in Carmel-by-the-Sea soon could have this address: 662 Monte Verde St. Seems pretty standard, right? Not in this wealthy little town on the Monterey Peninsula that has never had street addresses. For 109 years, residents have used directional descriptors — City Hall is on the east side of Monte Verde Street between Ocean and 7th avenues — instead of building numbers. And they

have given their homes whimsical names such as Sea Castle, Nut House and A Turn of Fraise. But this spring, every government building, business and house in the town of 3,200 people will be assigned a number. After decades of debate, city officials this month released a draft map of the one-square-mile town with proposed addresses, which could be implemented as soon as May. The address issue has long been contentious in artsy Carmel-by-the-Sea, where residents once threat-

ened to secede from California if they were forced to number their homes. They argued that the lack of addresses — along with other quirks, such as having no streetlights or sidewalks in residential areas, leading many to walk at night with flashlights — added to the vaunted “village character.” But the complaints about missed packages and mail-order medications, as well as trouble setting up banking accounts and utilities, kept piling up. And in the aging community — [See Carmel, A9]

TikTok finalizes U.S. joint venture

By CERY S DAVIES

The long and winding road over the fate of TikTok — the enormously popular social video platform that has been a force in American youth culture and entertainment — has come to an end. After years of questions about TikTok’s future in America, the social media platform and its Chinese parent company, ByteDance, have finalized the app’s U.S. joint venture. The announcement concludes a saga that began six years ago, when President Trump during his first term sought to ban the platform, citing national security concerns involving ByteDance. Trump shifted his views after ByteDance and its affiliates agreed to divest majority ownership of U.S. operation to an American-led investor group. The joint venture deal was established under an executive order signed by Trump in September. In an announcement posted Thursday, TikTok said the U.S. joint venture now has three managing investors: Silver Lake, Oracle and Emirat investment firm MGX, each holding 15%, with ByteDance retaining 19.9% of investments. The remainder is owned by a host of investment companies, some of which previously invested in ByteDance. The new firm will be headed by Adam Presser, who previously worked as TikTok’s head of operations and trust and safety. He will join a seven-member, majority-American board of directors that includes TikTok’s Chief Executive Shou Zi Chew. In a Truth Social post, Trump thanked Chinese leader Xi Jinping “for working with us and, ultimately, approving the Deal” and said it was a “dramatic, final, and beautiful conclusion.” “I am so happy to have helped in saving TikTok!” he wrote. “I only hope that long [See TikTok, A12]

Ex-Dodger Puig faces federal trial

By STEVE HENSON

Yasiel Puig’s name conjures indelible images to Dodgers fans. Mammoth home runs. Laser-like throws from the outfield. Distributing goodie bags during visits to Children’s Hospital Los Angeles. Also, tardiness to games, impulsive base-running mistakes and — more recent and egregious — charges of lying to federal investigators about his suspected involvement in illegal sports betting. Puig, 35, has been on trial

this week in a federal court in Los Angeles, charged with obstruction of justice and two counts of making false statements to investigators. He faces up to 20 years in prison. In August, in his most recent public comment, Puig posted a statement on X that included: “This story isn’t over yet, and you weren’t told the full story the first time.” A timeline of Puig’s tenure with the Dodgers, his admitted illegal gambling and his interactions with federal investigators that led to the [See Puig, A9]



CARLOS SANTIAGO Eyepix Group  
**YASIEL PUIG** at a batting competition in Veracruz, Mexico, in 2024.

Starmer slams Trump remarks

American president falsely said that non-U.S. NATO troops avoided front lines in Afghanistan. **WORLD, A2**

Olympian is held on drug charges

Former Canadian snowboarder was head of an organization that trafficked narcotics through L.A., U.S. officials allege. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

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**Markets** ..... **A12**  
**Opinion Voices** ..... **A13**

Boba behemoth goes Hollywood

China’s Mixue chain opens its first U.S. store, sparking its vast expansion plan. **BUSINESS, A10**

Kicking in at the right time?

Rams’ special teams, still a work in progress, may be key in the NFC title game. **SPORTS, B12**

Weather

A morning sprinkle. L.A. Basin: 65/45. **B8**

